



Delaware County Council Meeting August 24th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cOR5yD6Ed8
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Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: August 24, 2021

Location: Commissioners' Courtroom

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at [00:00:18](#) by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Webb, Mr. Alexander (Presiding Officer/President).
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Tony [00:00:26](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Motion to approve the July 27th regular meeting minutes (noting a spoken correction from an erroneous reference to June) and the August 12th special

meeting minutes.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:34 Resolution 2021-032: Refinancing of Morrison Road TIF District Bonds**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Pikel, representing the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission (accompanied by Joe Retz, Counsel for the Redevelopment Commission).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented as an interest rate reduction refinancing of bonds for the Morrison Road TIF district, saving county taxpayers approximately \$351,000 (after factoring in bond issuance, legal, and accounting costs of \$129,000). The refinancing does not extend bond terms. Additional revenue generated will fund road paving projects in the Morrison Road TIF area in 2021 (including Morrison Road, Benton Road, Claire Lane, Lantern Park neighborhood, Bethel Avenue, and Baker Lane). The City of Muncie and Town of Yorktown have previously approved the measure unanimously.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **02:30:21 Resolution 2021-033: Refinancing of Park One TIF District Bonds**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Pikel, representing the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A companion refinancing resolution for the Park One TIF district bonds, saving taxpayers approximately \$189,000 after accounting for \$119,000 in bond issuance costs. Terms are not extended, and interest rates are reduced.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:26:18 Commissioners' Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Commissioners / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfers involving Maintenance Superintendent (-\$7,173.46 to +\$7,173.46 for transition/retirement payout and part-time overlap) and Human Resources Assistant (\$10,781.51 line adjustment due to staff turnover and new hire start dates).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:30:02 Jail Salary & Wages Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Staff / Admin.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Line-item adjustments within the jail budget to accommodate correctional officer and corporal staffing allocations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).

- **00:32:18 Public Defenders Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfers moving \$11,500 within salary lines and \$15,000 from attorney fees to contract attorneys (00:32:37).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:33:22 Purdue Extension Budget Transfer & Secretary Compensation Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Molly Hunt, Purdue Extension Area 7 Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to adjust \$1,587.46 from travel expenses to secretary salary to retroactively cover a missed probationary period salary increase from 2020 (when pandemic closures delayed administrative processing). Awaiting formal guidance/approval from the State Board of Accounts (SBOA) and Department of Local Government Finance (DLGF) regarding the cross-fiscal-year adjustment.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table 00:39:54 passed by roll call vote (7-0) to await state agency guidance.
- **00:40:29 Cumulative Bridge Fund Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Angie, County Highway/Bridge Engineer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$11,558 from bridge tech to traffic tech/inspector to correctly align position job descriptions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:42:47 Jail LOIT (JAJ) Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff salary line adjustments reflecting ongoing correctional officer turnover and burning off of accrued time.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:43:35 Public Defenders Supplemental Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Dept.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$500 from witness fees to office supplies.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:51:52 Statewide 911 / Communications Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Staff / Interim Director Barry.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive line-item adjustments across communication technician salaries, overtime allocation (\$24,000 increase driven by mandatory overtime from severe staffing shortages), telephone backup center, and funding for the interim 911 director position.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:48:00 Additional Communications & Jail Addendum Transfers**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:52:12 Statewide 911 Salary & Wages Transfer**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:52:52 EMS Capital Improvement New Appropriation**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS Staff (00:57:13).
- **Deliberation Summary:** New appropriation of \$129,760 for an ambulance re-chassis project. Officials noted re-chassising costs about \$80,000 less than a new vehicle and extends box utility by 5-6 years, though manufacturing wait times have stretched up to 300 days due to supply chain backlogs.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **01:00:01 Cumulative Bridge Fund New Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Angie, County Bridge Engineer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$325,000 total across Bridge 86 (\$100,000 for planned replacement on 650 East at Campbell Creek), Bridge 112 (\$75,000 for design/right-of-way supported by 80% federal rural funding on 600 South), Bridge 193 (\$50,000 for superstructure replacement on Memorial Drive with federal backing), and \$100,000 for mandatory biennial bridge inspections (01:00:13).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **01:05:06 Family Recovery Court Grant Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator 01:05:24.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$2,870 to cover health insurance benefits through year-end for a staff member transitioned to the newly awarded Family Recovery Court grant starting July 1st.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **01:07:33 Board Appointment: Animal Care Board**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council addressed a vacancy on the Animal Care Board requiring a registered Democrat to maintain political balance. Mary was nominated and appointed.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0) 01:09:13.
- **01:09:50 Review of Maximum Levies and Tax Caps**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual statutory review of taxing unit maximum levies and tax caps for local schools, townships, and municipalities.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion for “no recommendation” 01:10:39 approved by roll call vote (7-0).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:14:42 Chris Broderick:** Submitted questions via electronic comment regarding the status of pay increases and pay matrix adjustments for county deputies and correctional officers.
- **01:16:03 Margaret Nickel (01:16:04):** Spoke as a facilitator for the Muncie 912 Tea Party, inviting elected officials to a community event on September 11th at Glad Tidings Church

covering Critical Race Theory (CRT), Social Emotional Learning (SEL), and the 1619 Project.

- **01:23:36 Stephen Brand (01:23:38):** Spoke as a local employer representing the Muncie Manufacturing Alliance, noting over 600 open advanced manufacturing jobs in the county. Addressed intense wage competition and expressed strong support for raising compensation for the Delaware County Sheriff's Department, stating he would support a modest tax increase if necessary to retain public safety personnel.
- **01:26:21 Captain Tony Johnson (01:26:24):** Spoke on behalf of the Delaware County Sheriff's Office (25-year veteran). Highlighted severe pay disparities compared to neighboring agencies (Muncie Police Department offering hiring bonuses and higher starting wages, Ball State, Yorktown, and local hospitals), retention losses of experienced deputies and correctional staff, pandemic service risks, and jail officer starting wages at \$16.10/hour. Urged the council to prioritize substantial pay adjustments during upcoming budget hearings.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Budget hearings are scheduled to begin on the Wednesday following Labor Day, running intensive sessions leading up to budget adoption on October 12th.
- **Adjournment:**
 - Motion to adjourn passed by voice vote / roll call **01:33:30**. Meeting adjourned.

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